

answers given by his competitors – partly because they were using vocal responses, which Watson wasn't built to take as input.

The second embarrassing incident occurred during a round on the category U.S. Cities. The host gave the clue: "Its largest airport was named for a World War II hero; its second largest, for a World War II battle." Watson responded with Toronto – a Canadian city. Its researchers offered the explanation that since "U.S. City" wasn't specifically a part of the question, Watson was unable to make the distinction. They also suggested that the existence of several cities in the U.S. named Toronto could have confused Watson. To its credit, the next option on Watson's list of possible answers was Chicago – the correct answer.

## Beyond the game

Beyond Jeopardy, the technology behind Watson can be adapted to solve problems and drive progress in various fields. The computer has the ability to sift through vast amounts of data and return precise answers, ranking its confidence in its answers.

Watson's ability to understand the meaning and context of human language, and rapidly process information to find precise answers to complex questions, holds enormous potential to transform how computers help people accomplish tasks in business and their personal lives.

Watson will enable people to rapidly find specific answers to complex questions. The technology could be applied in areas such as healthcare, for accurately diagnosing patients, to improve online self-service help desks, to provide tourists and citizens with specific information regarding cities, prompt customer support via phone, and much more. 